

in ActionScript can be described as complex data types as they represent a set of values which are grouped together. For instance, if we consider a variable having a data type such as Date, it will hold a single value.

Though 'date' is considered as a single value by declaring and creating a Date variable, internally the computer will consider it as a group of several values that, put together, define a single date. Most of the built-in data types that are found in Flash Action script are basically complex data types. Some of the most important complex data types that are found in ActionScript include:

MovieClip: This data type is related to the clip symbol.

TextField: The TextField data type is frequently used in ActionScript which is a dynamic and input text field.

SimpleButton: This data type is related to a button symbol.

Date: The Date data type gives suitable and relevant information about a single moment in time.

Another two prominent and frequently used words that are used as synonyms for data types are the 'class' and 'object'. A class is basically used when we define a data type. On the other hand, an object is defined as the instance of the class. Let us take an example where the same thing has been expressed in three different ways.

The data type of the variable myName is a Number.

The variable myName is a Number instance.

The variable myName is a Number object.

The variable myName is an instance of the Number class.

It is to be noted that variables in flash have the capacity to accept any type of data at any time even if the variable earlier had a numeric value. It is also possible to overwrite a different data type. For instance:

```
var myName;  
myName = "Jack";
```